

STUMPRIDER · DESIGN DECISIONS REGISTER

StumpRider design decisions register

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

Document ID	SMR-DEC-001	Version	0.2
Status	Draft	Date	2026-10-03
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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stumprider		
Source	docs/06-design-decisions.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.2	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Round 2. Amish decided O1 to O4 as recommended (SMR-DDR-003); two new questions proposed, awaiting Amish
0.1	2026-10-03	Amish Chadha	Register opened; design decisions made under Amish's 2026-10-03 pre-approvals; four requirement decisions proposed, awaiting Amish

StumpRider design decisions register

Every design decision still to be made, and every decision made, in one place. Each decision is argued in full in its decision record under `docs/decisions/` or in `docs/REVIEW.md`; this register is the index Amish works from. The build plan (`docs/05-build-plan.md`) describes the design as it stands and does not list decisions.

Safety: Several entries set safety limits (the pin rating and its calibration, kneeling, slackening the line, the interim rule on small canoes, life jackets). Each takes the conservative option and names the evidence that would relax it. StumpRider is never a reason to keep children on boats and never replaces a life jacket.

■ Open decisions

Amish decided O1 to O4 on 2026-10-03 (SMR-DDR-003); they are listed under Decisions made. The questions below were raised while carrying them out; the state, options and recommendation for each are in `docs/REVIEW.md` (session 2026-10-03, round 2).

Table 1. Open decisions, all proposed, awaiting Amish.

#	Decision needed	Options	Recommendation	Affects in the build	Source
O5	R7 for the aluminium prototype: the carried kit is 4.22 kg with the hook head, 0.22 kg over 4 kg (4.02 kg without it); the local production variant carries 3.56 kg	A: judge R7 on the local production variant and accept 4.22 kg for the aluminium prototype, which exists to measure the tool; B: lighten the prototype: pole head socket of 38 x 2 tube 80 long (about 0.17 kg less) and the hook head carried only when wrapped nets are expected (3.85 kg carried, 4.05 kg with the hook head); C: restate R7 to 4.5 kg	A: no change to the prototype; R7 is shown by the variant at TRL 4	None	SMR-CAL-001, M11 and O10
O6	R9 at its limit: with the hook head one smith needs about 8.0 h for a kit, the whole of a working day	A: accept and time it in the TRL 4 build trial; B: have the HDPE roller turned and the clamp screw made by a supplier, saving about 30 min of the smith's time (estimate)	A	None	SMR-CAL-001, T1

■ To confirm when parts are bought

These are facts that can only be settled with real parts, a real canoe or the first partner. None changes a decision; each may change a size or a limit.

Table 2. Items to confirm.

#	What to confirm	Why it matters	Source
1	Shear strength of the chosen wire reel (48 MPa assumed): ten pins broken on CalRig	Pin rating and its band (R3)	SMR-CAL-001, A1; SMR-DDR-002, A2
2	38 mm tube with a 32.4 mm bore, or how much opening 38 x 3 tube needs	Sleeve fit	SMR-DDR-002, A1
3	Size, mass and crew of the partner's canoes; gunwale thickness and clear side depth	Heel check (R3) and crutch fit	SMR-CAL-001, A2 to A5; SMR-DDR-002, A3 and A4
4	How often nets hook and how often they wrap, from partner crews	R1 and decision O1	SMR-PRB-001
5	Friction of the partner's netting on wet bark (0.3 to 0.5 assumed)	Freeing pull (R1)	SMR-CAL-001, A7
6	Local prices for aluminium tube, bamboo, galvanising and foam near the first fishery	R10 and decision O4	bom/bom.csv
7	Bent ring holds 112 mm mean diameter within 2 mm	Joint gaps and ear alignment	SMR-DDR-002, A5
8	Mesh damage at the pin rating on 90 to 150 mm mesh	R4	SMR-REQ-001

■ Value engineering

Value-engineering target: USD 2,000 (a hypothetical control target, not a limit). Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 292.50 for the prototype run of three kits and calibration wire (USD 1,707.50 under the target); one kit is USD 95.50 with the hook head. The local production variant (SMR-DDR-003, bom/bom-local-variant.csv) is USD 55.90 a kit. Main cost drivers and savings worth trying:

- The largest lines are the aluminium pole, sleeves and rivets (31 % of a kit), galvanising (13 %) and the crutch (13 %).
- Savings worth trying: bamboo pole sections with steel ferrules (about USD 22 a kit); one crutch and jiggling weight shared by five canoes at a landing (about USD 18 a kit); galvanising a batch of kits together, which spreads the galvaniser's minimum lot; zinc-rich paint only where no galvaniser is near (about USD 9, at some risk to R8).
- Smith's labour (about 7.7 hours a kit) is not in the parts cost; a partner workshop making kits in batches would cut it.

■ Decisions made

Table 3. Decisions made.

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
2026-10-03	TRL 2 review items D1 to D10: hinged two-half ring with a pinned gate; three-section aluminium pole for the prototype; one shear pin rating, 2.0 mm soft aluminium, 302 N nominal, calibrated per reel; the pin carries push and pull; operating rules (kneel, slacken, life jackets, tether tied off, cut rather than capsize, interim rule on canoes under 7 m); jiggling weight pinned to the tang; foam float winder; clamp-on roller crutch; handed out only through child-protection partners, first candidates to approach (Challenging Heights, a Volta landing-site committee through the Fisheries Commission, a Ghanaian university fisheries department; none approached); requirement targets kept	Amish, pre-approval of 2026-10-03: "start with the first 14 repos from the list of 29 projects. I pre-approve the batch runs along with any recommendations you come up with. I also accept any cost overruns or variations from the assumed scope cost." and "Proceed with the remaining 15 scaffolds"	SMR-DDR-001
2026-10-03	Design for construction, changes C1 to C12, and assumptions A1 to A5	Amish, same pre-approvals	SMR-DDR-002
2026-10-03	Safety stops S1 to S5 and the first checks, including pin calibration and a moored heel test before any use on a snag (conservative; a gate, not relaxed)	Amish, same pre-approvals	SMR-BLD-001, sections 5 and 6
2026-10-03	Appearance model departures for the renders: a plank deck and a forearm and hand beside the packed kit; a short net line over a branch and a cut-short pole for the detail view; the shear pin shown red	Amish, same pre-approvals	docs/REVIEW.md, TRL 3 section
2026-10-03	O1, R1: option B, a hook head pinned into the same fork with the same shear pin, made and tried beside the ring in the TRL 4 staged-snag trials, with walking the ring back taught either way	Amish: "i approve all of the 47 recommendations provided by you. Execute them."	SMR-DDR-003, D-A1
2026-10-03	O2, R3 (safety): option A now, the interim rule (only canoes of 7 m or more with three crew) lettered on the pole head; option C as the planned TRL 4 step, heel tests by canoe class setting a pin per class	Amish, as above	SMR-DDR-003, D-A2
2026-10-03	O3, R7: option A, crutch left clamped on the canoe and jiggling weight kept at the landing; aluminium prototype stays the TRL 3 design; bamboo judged under O4	Amish, as above	SMR-DDR-003, D-A3
2026-10-03	O4, R10: option C, the local production variant (bamboo sections, crutch and weight shared by five canoes), costed and built alongside the aluminium prototype at TRL 4	Amish, as above	SMR-DDR-003, D-A4

■ Change log

- 2026-10-03, v0.2: O1 to O4 decided as recommended and carried into the design (SMR-DDR-003); O5 and O6 opened.